



Laboratoire sur la

Prefiguration

Lab

Seven pedagogical innovation ideas for an engaging first-year B.Com. experience

Recommendations drawn from a series of three "prefigurative workshops" held in September 2025 at Telfer School of Management

Report coordinated by **Mathieu Bouchard**
Assistant Professor of Strategy and Organization

Drafted by **Hamza Tawdi**
Edited by **Phuong Tran**
Prefiguration Lab Student Researchers

Thank you!

This report reflects the collective work of students, professors, and pedagogical professionals at the Telfer School of Management, united in reimagining the first year of the B.Com. program. Supported by the **Dom-Herrick Fund for Experiential Learning and Entrepreneurship** and **the Green Academy**, the workshops provided a space for open dialogue and creative collaboration. We also thank all those who contributed with their administrative support and support. Their names are presented below in alphabetical order by first name.

Abdul Kane, Adam Balafrej, Ahmad Mahdi Formuly, Amanda Wilson, Anastasiia Komisarenko, Ashley Gouveia, Blake Gauthier, Camila Estrada, Dan Ngenzi Ya Ruty, Daina Mazutis, Dana Hyde, Devan Hemstead, Éric Nelson, Francesca Nitica, Haniyah Aamir, Isabelle Décarie, Jade Christina Blaise, Jasmin Manseau, Jean-François Aubert, Jolene Hurtubise, Julien Leclair-Dionne, Kimberly Nault, Linda Lizotte, Matteo Martone, Matthew Archibald, Maemonah Arshad, Marie Astel Gaye, Mero Obuwoma, Mohamed Chelli, Qiu Chen, Rafaella De Castro, Sara-Maude Couture, Sam Sharifi, Omar Al Kanouni, Owen Andrew Parkins, Phuong Tran, Takwa Youssef, Thea Peters, Umar Ruhi



Mathieu Bouchard

Assistant Professor of Strategy and Organization

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overview

This report presents seven pedagogical innovation ideas developed through collaborative workshops with students and instructors. The goal is to create a more engaging, coherent, and participatory first-year experience that prepares students for a rapidly evolving world.

**Shared ownership • Active participation •
Collective learning**

Challenges Identified

- Fragmented governance and limited transparency in decision-making.
- Need for stronger faculty support and recognition of pedagogy as a core competency.
- Classroom relations that must evolve from transmissive to collaborative learning.
- Student experience perceived as fragmented, lacking coherence and progression.
- Ethical and responsible integration of Artificial Intelligence in teaching and learning.

WHAT EMERGED?

**SHARED OWNERSHIP
ACTIVE PARTICIPATION
COLLECTIVE LEARNING**

These principles form the backbone of the proposed reforms.

Goals and Objectives



Innovation Governance

Create a Student–Instructor Learning Experience Committee to strengthen dialogue and guide pedagogical innovation.



Pedagogical Mentorship

Recognize teaching as a craft through mentorship and certification pathways for instructors and PhD candidates.



Faculty Collaborative Spaces

Create recurring forums where instructors exchange practices, experiment, and learn from one another.



Collective Learning Classrooms

Transform classrooms into active learning environments based on dialogue and participation.



Continuous Feedback Culture

Encourage ongoing feedback between students and instructors to support real-time adjustments.



Coherent First-Year Learning Journey

Design the first year as a structured pathway supported by an integration course and shared competencies.



Student-Led Digital Learning Ecosystem

Develop Telfer Essentials, a centralized platform connecting resources, services, and student engagement.

WORKSHOP METHODOLOGY



OBJECTIVE

Collect perceptions, expectations, and proposals from:

- Professors
- Students
- Pedagogical advisors

Ground reforms in lived academic experience.



METHODS

- Small group discussions
- Plenary exchanges
- Interactive visual aids (post-its, idea boards, diagrams)



ANALYSIS

Comparative, descriptive reading of activity reports

- No quantitative weighting
- Focus on depth and representativeness of ideas



DATA COLLECTION

Observation notes, verbatim, grouped by themes (motivation, consistency, integrity, digital innovation, student experience)



APPROACH

- Participatory, qualitative, and exploratory.
- Inspired by collaborative education research.
- Designed to ensure that recommendations directly reflect the voices of the Telfer community.

→ The focus was on depth, convergence of themes, and representativeness of concerns.



Workshop 1

Instructors

Teaching realities, structural constraints, motivation, recognition.

Workshop 2

Students

Learning experience, course coherence, pedagogical expectations.

Workshop 3

Mixed Groups

Cross-perspective dialogue to identify shared solutions and strengthen trust.

CREATE A STUDENT-INSTRUCTOR PEDAGOGY INNOVATION COMMITTEE

Report/ Student's quote

"Often, we don't know how pedagogical decisions are made, or even why certain changes occur. A shared discussion space would create trust and ownership."
– Student

Report/ Instructor's quote

"Structured dialogue would help us better align our decisions with student needs and strengthen program coherence."
– Instructor



✓ Purpose

Establish a Student–Instructor Learning Experience Committee that creates a structured space for dialogue and collaboration. The committee will allow students and instructors to co-construct pedagogical innovations and help ensure that the B.Com. program evolves in line with student needs and learning experiences.

✓ Implementation

Form a committee composed of five students and three instructors, with one instructor serving as liaison to the Undergraduate Programs Committee (UPC).

The committee will meet four times per year, with student members compensated and instructor participation formally recognized to value their contributions.

✓ Impact

This initiative strengthens trust, shared ownership, and collaboration between students and instructors.

It also supports continuous pedagogical innovation and provides the UPC with informed input from both communities.



Creating a shared governance space for students and instructors lays the foundation for ongoing pedagogical innovation and a more collaborative learning culture within the B.Com. program.

PEDAGOGY MENTORING PROGRAM



Instructors have strong subject expertise, but changing student expectations and new educational technologies are reshaping how students learn. At the same time, doctoral students often lack structured opportunities to develop effective teaching skills.

"Discussing pedagogical practices with colleagues helps us refine our approaches and adapt our teaching to better support students' learning."
— Instructor

Our approach include:

CONTENT

Instructors have strong subject expertise, but fast-changing student needs and technology are creating a gap in effective teaching. Doctoral students have useful insights but need structured support to build strong teaching skills.

RECOMMENDATION

Create a teaching mentorship program pairing experienced instructors with junior instructors and PhD candidates. Build it as a certification pathway that strengthens and recognizes pedagogical skills.

IMPLEMENTATION

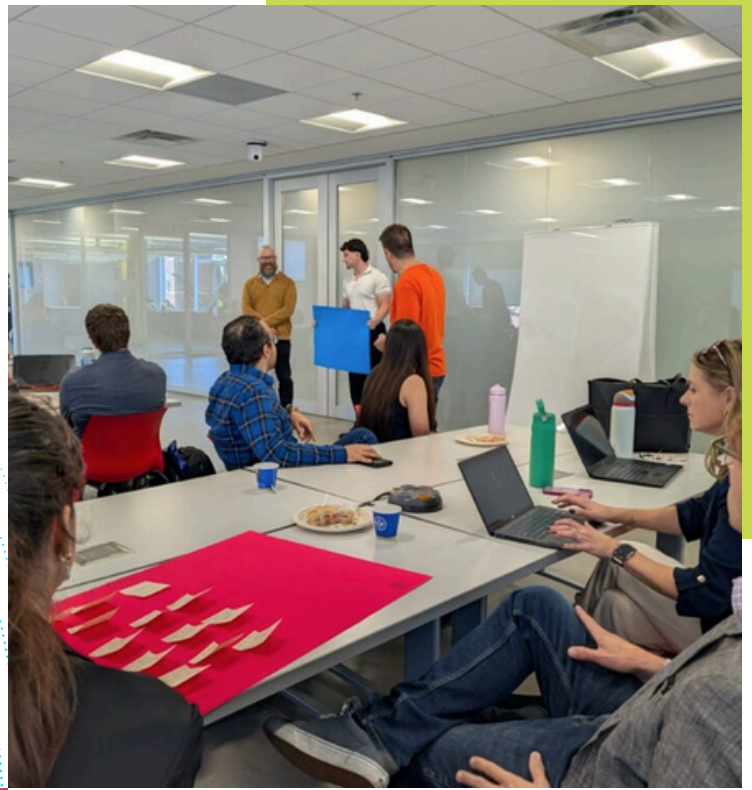
Make the program mandatory for PhD candidates and open to all instructors. Match mentors and mentees thoughtfully, include course shadowing and reflection, and formally recognize their contributions.

IMPACT

The program raises teaching quality by sharing expertise across the faculty. It builds confidence and skills for newer instructors and strengthens a collaborative, innovative teaching culture.



Instructor Collaboration & Learning Circles



Context

Instructors value their teaching autonomy but also want more opportunities to exchange effective pedagogical practices. Without structured collaboration, large differences in teaching styles can sometimes appear as inconsistency to students.

Impact

These exchanges encourage collaboration across disciplines and experience levels, allowing instructors to expand their pedagogical toolbox while maintaining autonomy. This strengthens teaching quality and fosters a culture of continuous pedagogical innovation.

Recommendation

Create dedicated spaces where instructors regularly exchange teaching practices and experiences, fostering collaboration and continuous pedagogical improvement.

- ✓ Regular meetups to discuss teaching ideas and challenges
- ✓ Include PhD candidates so they learn from experienced instructors
- ✓ Share effective practices to strengthen teaching across the program

Implementation

Organize regular monthly gatherings where instructors discuss teaching practices, challenges, and innovations. Meetings can be held both in person and online, with rotating leadership and administrative support to coordinate logistics.



COLLECTIVE CLASSROOMS

From Transmission to Collective Learning



CONTEXT & DIAGNOSIS

“Students are not less capable , they simply learn differently.” - Professor

Traditional transmissive models struggle in a digital attention economy.

Learning must move from passive reception to active construction.

VISION

The classroom becomes a space of collective learning where:

- Instructors guide and structure
- Students actively participate and reflect
- Knowledge is constructed through interaction

Teaching becomes a shared responsibility.

RECOMMENDATION

Transform the classroom into a dynamic, reciprocal learning environment where:

- Instructors guide and facilitate
- Students actively exchange and collaborate
- Learning occurs through discussion, application, and experimentation



IMPLEMENTATION

- Structure sessions around short cycles: Theory → Application → Discussion
- Integrate participatory tools: Polls, case analysis, small-group debates
- Provide pedagogical design support
- Share practices through faculty collaborative spaces (Ideas 1–3)

IMPACT

- ✓ Students shift from passive recipients to active learning partners.
- ✓ Instructors maintain autonomy while experimenting confidently.
- ✓ Trust, curiosity, and shared ownership increase.





CONTINUOUS FEEDBACK CULTURE



VISION

Promote a culture of continuous feedback that strengthens trust and collaboration between students and instructors. When feedback is framed as a shared tool for improvement rather than an evaluation, it encourages open dialogue and transparency in the learning process.

RECOMMENDATION

Introduce simple and regular feedback mechanisms that allow instructors to gather student input and adjust their teaching throughout the semester. Continuous feedback ensures that the learning experience can evolve while the course is still in progress.



IMPLEMENTATION

- Instructors administer short anonymous surveys during the semester, typically including 3–5 targeted questions on pace, clarity, and workload.
- The results remain confidential to the instructor and are used to adjust teaching approaches in real time.
- At the beginning of the following class, instructors briefly communicate the adjustments made in response to student feedback.
- To support this practice, Telfer implements a rapid feedback tool integrated into Brightspace that is easy to use, confidential, and action-oriented.

IMPACT

- Continuous feedback demonstrates that instructors listen and adapt to student needs.
- Students feel encouraged to share honest and constructive input, while courses become more responsive and engaging.
- Over time, this practice strengthens mutual trust and supports a more collaborative learning environment.





COHERENT FIRST-YEAR LEARNING JOURNEY

Vision

Create a first-year experience that is coherent, supportive, and easier for students to navigate during their transition to university.

Recommendation

Design the first year as a structured learning pathway that helps students progressively build academic skills and confidence.

Challenge

Many students experience their first year as fragmented and overwhelming, with courses that feel disconnected and expectations that are not always clear.

Core Element

Introduce an integration course that helps students understand program expectations, academic methods, and the connections between courses.

CREATING COHERENCE

IMPLEMENTATION

Align first-year courses around shared competencies such as analysis, collaboration, communication, and critical thinking.

STUDENT EXPERIENCE

Students gain clearer direction, stronger academic foundations, and a better understanding of how their courses connect.

IMPACT

A coherent learning journey reduces confusion, increases engagement, and strengthens students' confidence as they begin their studies.

STUDENT- LED DIGITAL LEARNING ECOSYSTEM



"We often discover clubs, services, or study tools too late. Everything exists, but it is not organized in a way that makes it easy to find when we need it." - Student

"A clear entry point that brings together essential resources would make orientation easier for students and benefit the entire community." - Professor

RECOMMENDATION

Extend the Telfer experience beyond the classroom through a centralized digital space co-created with students.

- Develop "Telfer Essentials", integrated with Brightspace and supported by the Academic Department, to centralize:
- Academic resources
- Support services
- Clubs and events
- Faculty initiatives

The platform becomes a living space that reflects student needs and fosters engagement.



IMPLEMENTATION

- Platform architecture defined by a joint student-instructor-advisor group
- Paid student leadership in web development
- Dedicated "Library module" highlighting research tools and events
- Student committee responsible for updates and moderation
- Biannual activity reports and user consultations



IMPACT

- Positions students as active stewards of their learning environment.
- Develops autonomy, digital leadership, and platform management skills.
- Creates a cohesive academic ecosystem where instructors contribute content and advisors ensure coherence and accessibility.



SUMMARY



Reinventing the First Year as a Collective Commitment

This initiative does not aim to “fix” a program, but to redefine the meaning of education.

By aligning governance, pedagogy, student experience, and ethics, Telfer affirms that:

- 01 to educate minds capable of discernment, intellectual rigour, and openness.
- 02 In a world where information is abundant but meaning is often scarce, education must go beyond knowledge transmission.
- 03 The quality of a program is measured by its ability to cultivate: curiosity, critical thinking, and intellectual responsibility.

Together, these ideas support a first-year experience built on shared ownership, active participation, and collective learning, creating a stronger and more engaging foundation for the B.Com. program.